

Usability Engineering – II

Assistive Devices for those on the Spectrum

In today's world technology is making rapid advancements, of them there has especially been a massive growth in the market for wearable devices. However, despite all the improvements there seems to be a visible disparity in regards to assistive devices being made specifically for people who are on the spectrum (ADHD, Autism, Schizophrenia, etc.). The challenges of a person who is on the spectrum are sadly a long list, however I would like to narrow it down to the how we can go about creating and testing a device to help locate a person who is lost or in distress. While it would be difficult to identify all the challenges, in this week's assignment I would at least like to offer a simple understanding of some ways we could go about it from the prescribed topics that we we're asked to read on.

- **Choosing the most appropriate setting/environment:** It is in my opinion that a Natural Setting would be the most appropriate for a device whose primary function is for locating a person who is lost as more often than not mentally challenged patients tend to wander off into public spaces and have no means to find their way back. Hence a Natural Setting will guarantee that we can test for various usability testing.

NOTE: A controlled setting may still be required to test other functionalities but primarily a natural setting should be preferred to be used more often

- **Choosing the most appropriate Inspections:** A Heuristic evaluation of the model in my opinion be the most effective and best way to go about it, since Heuristic evaluations first of all require a Live Tester to be present in order to proceed and further more they are designed to be able to address to specific complications and the help ease the mental load of making a decision.

NOTE: Walkthroughs may be a viable inspection model too but since most Walkthroughs do not require a Live User and instead rely on algorithms and data models there is an off chance that it might not be able to understand the limitations and qualms of a mentally challenged patient and hence not be able to give us the most appropriate result.